

PaySync

A browser extension that unifies a shopper's Buy-Now-Pay-Later payments into one calendar and warns them before a new plan collides with a week that's already loaded.

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1. Summary

PaySync is a browser extension that gives Buy-Now-Pay-Later (BNPL) users the one view no provider, bank, or budgeting app offers them: **a single calendar of every installment they owe, merged across all providers, with the weeks where payments pile up flagged in advance.** Its core job is to catch a **payment collision** — several due dates landing in the same few days on an account the user isn't tracking, which is the real driver of missed BNPL payments — **before** the user opens the plan that causes it.

At checkout, when a shopper is about to split a purchase, PaySync checks that plan's first payment against their existing schedule and warns in concrete terms: **"This drops \$140 into the week of the 6th — you already have \$95 due then."** It captures each purchase automatically from the confirmation page for one-tap confirmation, and translates late fees into an effective APR so the true cost of a "0% interest" plan is visible at the point of decision. Everything runs locally in the browser — no account, no bank connection, no payment data leaves the device.

2. Background & problem

Pay-in-4 BNPL is now a default checkout option for a generation of online shoppers, marketed as "0% interest" so its real cost is invisible at the point of decision. But the sharpest problem isn't any single plan's cost — it's that **each purchase is a separate plan with its own due dates, and nothing shows the shopper how those dates stack up together.**

- **Fragmentation.** Purchases across Klarna, Afterpay, Zip and Sezzle are separate biweekly schedules the shopper never sees in one place; each provider shows only its own plan.
- **Invisible collisions.** Those schedules drift into alignment — several plans can debit the same account within a few days the shopper never anticipated. The bank sees the debits but not that they're BNPL; the providers don't see each other.
- **Punitive late fees.** A missed installment triggers a flat fee that, on a small short-dated balance, is enormous annualized — a \$7 fee on a \$150 plan is an effective APR near 80%. But the miss itself is a timing collision, not overspending.

Budgeting apps sit **after** the fact and don't see the checkout moment; providers have no incentive to show cross-provider exposure — it's the number that would make a shopper pause. **A merged, forward-looking BNPL calendar delivered at the moment of decision is the gap PaySync fills.**

3. Market opportunity

BNPL is one of the fastest-growing consumer-credit categories, used by a large and rising share of online shoppers, with a meaningful minority carrying multiple active plans at once. **That multi-plan cohort is the addressable core** — collision detection has no value for someone carrying a single plan, but it is decision-changing for anyone juggling several.

Why now: regulators (CFPB in the US) are moving BNPL toward credit-card-like disclosure, and rising plan-stacking has put consumer-harm from BNPL in the spotlight. A tool that surfaces true cost and cross-provider exposure is timely with both users and the regulatory direction of travel.

Positioning: not another budgeting app and not a lender — **cash-flow radar for BNPL**, delivered at the one moment the user can still choose otherwise.

4. Target users

The primary market is **younger, high-frequency BNPL users with variable or tightly-managed cash flow** — where plan-stacking is both most common and most damaging.

Segment	Why they're the wedge
Gen-Z & younger millennials (18–34)	Highest pay-in-4 adoption; treat BNPL as a default checkout button, so they accumulate overlapping plans fastest.
Variable-income earners (students, gig & shift workers)	Income doesn't land on fixed dates, so a fixed biweekly due date is far more likely to collide with a low-balance week — the exact risk they face.
Thin-buffer budgeters	Living close to the account balance means a bunched-up week is an overdraft or a missed payment, not an inconvenience. The calendar is genuinely decision-changing.
Privacy-wary users	Won't connect a bank aggregator or hand BNPL logins to a third party; a local-only tool is the only kind they'll adopt.

5. Goals & non-goals

Goals

- **Show the merged calendar.** A single view of every upcoming BNPL payment across all providers, with pile-up weeks flagged.
- **Catch collisions before they happen.** When a new plan is opened, warn — with a real date and amount — if its first payment lands in an already-loaded week.
- **Make the true cost legible.** Translate a missed-payment fee into a credit-card-comparable effective APR.
- **Earn trust through privacy.** Everything local; never touch payment data, bank logins, or require an account.

Non-goals

- **Not a bank aggregator.** No account connections or dashboard scraping; plan data is entered by the user or captured at checkout, stored locally.
- **Not a lender or broker.** It never initiates, applies for, or blocks a transaction.
- **Not automatic history recovery.** No email or statement parsing; capture is going-forward and confirmed.
- **Not financial advice.** Indicative estimates and an educational verdict, not a regulated recommendation.

6. Solution & key features

6.1 Payment-collision calendar (core)

- Each plan generates a schedule from its next-due date by provider cadence (biweekly for pay-in-4, monthly for Affirm-style); all plans merge into one sorted timeline.
- The timeline is bucketed into rolling 7-day windows; a window is flagged as a collision when two or more payments — or a dollar strain threshold — land in it, graded by severity.
- A calendar view lists every upcoming window with headline stats (payments ahead, total still to pay, crunch weeks).

6.2 Collision warning at checkout

- On a detected offer, PaySync drops the prospective plan's first payment onto the timeline and reports the worst window it would join, leading the verdict with a concrete, dated warning over any abstract stacking count or APR.

6.3 One-tap auto-capture

- A content script scores whether a page is a completed purchase (confirmation cues) vs. a browsing offer, so only real purchases are captured; it extracts price, provider, split, and due date and surfaces a prefilled confirm-to-add card. Confirm is the correction step — nothing is logged silently.

6.4 True-cost lens

- Expresses a missed-payment fee as an annualized rate over the plan's life against the average outstanding balance, making a flat fee comparable to a credit-card APR.

7. Early validation

A working prototype was tested with an initial group of four users. **Three of the four were found to be carrying overlapping BNPL payments — roughly \$100–\$120 landing in a single week — that they had not accounted for;** the fourth had none. Despite the small sample, the hit rate points to collisions being common rather than edge-case, and directly validates the core hypothesis that the problem is timing, not overspending. The immediate next step is a larger, more structured test (target 15–20 users) with consistent questions and a would-you-use-it signal to firm up the demand read.

8. Success metrics

Metric	Target	Why it matters
Collision-detection accuracy	No missed real overlaps	A missed collision is the failure the product exists to prevent.
Testers with an unaccounted collision surfaced	Baseline 3 of 4; re-measure at scale	Direct read on how common the core problem is.
"Would use it" signal in testing	Majority of a 15–20 person cohort	Early demand validation before further build.
Plans tracked per active user	Trend toward 2+	Calendar value scales

Metric	Target	Why it matters
		with how complete the plan set is.
Capture accuracy on supported checkouts	≥ 95% on demo + common flows	A missed purchase means no intervention.

9. Rollout & risks

Phased rollout

- **Phase 1 (built).** Merged calendar, checkout collision warning, one-tap auto-capture, and true-cost calculator, tuned to common phrasings and demo checkouts.
- **Phase 2.** Harden offer and confirmation-page detection across a short list of high-traffic retailers, site by site, measuring accuracy before adding each.
- **Phase 3.** Optional local reminders ahead of collision weeks and upcoming due dates; still fully local.

Key risks

Risk	Mitigation
Calendar is only as complete as the plans it knows about	Prompt to seed existing plans on first run; make auto-capture near-frictionless; state in-UI that unentered plans are invisible.
Due dates aren't always shown at checkout	Let the user set each plan's due date; default sensibly and flag when a date was guessed so it's corrected on confirm.
Detection breaks on unfamiliar checkout markup	Scope Phase 1 to common flows + demo; calculator and calendar always work as a manual fallback.
Users mistake estimates for exact provider terms	Label figures as indicative estimates and "not financial advice" on every surface.
Privacy concern about an extension reading checkout pages	Minimal permissions, no network calls, no payment-data read; stated plainly in-product.